

You open it. I run it.

AI Operations Partner · reconciled to Jay's June 22 Opening Plan · 429 McHenry Ave, Modesto CA · prepared June 24, 2026

BUILD-OUT

Jun 22 – Jul 28

SOFT OPEN

Jul 29 – 30

GRAND OPEN

Aug 1

WHAT JAY'S PLAN UNBLOCKED + THE TWO DECISIONS

Branch Status Map — Candelo × Frontier Pilot Package

Paths are relative to `Frontier_Organics/`. The commercial layer lives in `Pilot_Package/`. The delivery engine (already built, not rebuilt) lives in `Implementation_Package/` + `Control_Room/`.

0. Jay's June 22 plan — what it UNBLOCKED (the headline)

Jay sent his own **Frontier Organics — Briefing & Opening Plan (June 22, 2026)**. It does the opening/regulatory homework himself and sets a hard date. Four things we were blocked on are now **confirmed reality** — they move from BLOCKED to UNBLOCKED:

WAS BLOCKED	JAY'S PLAN CONFIRMS	NEW STATUS
Zoning at 429 McHenry (RESEARCH_FACTS flagged "McHenry targeted for Housing-Element rezoning — verify live zone before relying on old map")	429 McHenry is MU-P (= C-2 General Commercial) . Retail and on-site cosmetic melt/mix/fill both by-right . Production + post-production = 303 sq ft / ~11% , under the 25% accessory-use cap. No CUP (§10-3.201(b)).	UNBLOCKED — GREEN
Day-one production scope (I had raised the edible-tallow / USDA food question)	Cosmetics melt/mix/fill production ONLY . All food (frozen grass-fed beef, raw dairy, eggs, nuts) is vendor-stocked SEALED RESALE — no on-site food processing . The heavier USDA/FSIS food path is avoided by design .	UNBLOCKED — GREEN
Target opening date	Grand open Aug 1, 2026 . Build-out Jun 22–Jul 28; soft open Jul 29–30. This is now the deadline anchor for the whole pilot.	UNBLOCKED — DATED
Raw-dairy resale path	Cleared: no extra license beyond the county market permit, provided the supplying farm's CDFA Market Milk Permit + bottling licensing is verified and product is sold sealed (no opening/repackaging).	UNBLOCKED — GREEN

The single remaining regulatory long pole (per Jay): the **Stanislaus County DER retail market permit** — print + fax to **209-525-6774** (no e-filing). Everything else (zoning, dairy resale) is confirmed. *Candelo has taken this long pole off Jay's plate as its first deliverable — see Branch /.*

Two real decisions Jay's plan surfaces (not buried — see "Two open decisions" below): **POS = Square** (Jay's #1) vs our Shopify lean; **Inventory = Craftybase** (Jay's #1) vs Candelo's Control Room, which the build-vs-buy audit already replaced.

Entity note (do not conflate): Jay's plan states "**Frontier Organics LLC already exists**" (the WWOT/Jay side) and the store may need a **DBA "Frontier Organics – Local Natural Provisions."** That is **Jay's** entity. Candelo's \$2776 structure still needs **CANDELO** to be its own registered entity — separate and still open (Branch G).

Commercial / partnership layer (this build)

#	BRANCH	STATUS	ARTIFACT / MISSING INPUT
A	Offer one-pager	DONE (reframed)	Pilot_Package/A_Offer_OnePager.md — reframed to "you open it, I run it"
B	Pilot SOW + B2B IC Agreement (MSA + SOW)	DONE (template) · BLOCKED to sign	Pilot_Package/B_MSA_and_SOW_TEMPLATE.md — built; blocker: CA employment-attorney + CPA review before signing
C	Pricing & terms sheet	DONE (updated)	Pilot_Package/C_Pricing_and_Terms.md — founding \$0 + \$2,500/mo; Square POS + confirmed cosmetics-only scope folded in
D	Service operating model / runbook	DONE	Pilot_Package/D_Service_Operating_Model_Runbook.md — daily/weekly/monthly cadence mapped to the 18 branches
E	Pitch to Jay	DONE (sharpened)	Pilot_Package/E_Pitch_To_Jay.md — "you open it, I run it"; Control Room = live back-office from Aug 1
F	Onboarding sequence (first 2 weeks)	DONE	Pilot_Package/F_Onboarding_Sequence.md
G	Entity / blocker check	DONE (finding recorded)	Pilot_Package/G_Entity_and_Blocker_Check.md — Jay's gating-four now answered; Candelo entity still UNCONFIRMED
H	Integrate existing 18-branch package as delivery engine	DONE	Referenced throughout D, F, runbook + hub; Implementation_Package/ + Control_Room/ unchanged
I	Market-permit pre-fill (Candelo's first deliverable)	DONE (new)	Pilot_Package/H_Market_Permit_PreFill.md + ..._Market_Permit_PreFill.pdf — answer key + fax cover; Jay signs + faxes
J	6-week countdown board to Aug 1	DONE (new)	Pilot_Package/I_Six_Week_Countdown_Board.md + ..._Countdown_Board.pdf — who-does-what, Jun 24 → Aug 1

Close-out artifacts

BRANCH	STATUS	ARTIFACT / MISSING INPUT
Master pilot PDF (pitch + structure)	DONE (regenerated)	Frontier_Organics_Pilot_Package.pdf

BRANCH	STATUS	ARTIFACT / MISSING INPUT
overview, phone-readable)		
Browsable hub updated with Jay reconciliation + new deliverables	DONE	<code>frontier_package_hub/site/index.html</code> + mirror in <code>Candelo OS claude/_deploy/candelo-sites/frontier/index.html</code>
Deploy — phone-native (GitHub Pages) , not a Mac paste	DONE (staged) · BLOCKED on 1 token	Push from sandbox: <code>_deploy/candelo-sites/push.sh</code> (GitHub.com reachable). Blocker : one fine-grained PAT (phone-doable, one-time — see <code>_active/deploy_method_phone_native.md</code>).
Branch status map	DONE	this file
Brain capture	DONE	<code>Candelo OS claude/_active/frontier_organics_control_room.md</code> (Jay-plan reconciliation appended)

Two open decisions (surfaced, with Candelo's recommendation)

DECISION 1 — POS: SQUARE VS SHOPIFY

- **Jay leans Square (#1)**: free software, 2.6%+10¢ in-person, no contract, runs store + markets + online — **cheapest to start, best fit for the zero-out-of-pocket model**.
- **Our materials leaned Shopify** because Frontier already runs a **live Shopify store (71 products / 518 variants online)**.
- **Candelo recommendation — reconcile to Square for day-one retail + markets**. It matches Jay's pick and the \$0 model. The one wrinkle to decide *with Jay*: the existing Shopify **online** store — either (a) keep Shopify for online + Square in-store (two channels; Control Room unifies inventory across both), or (b) consolidate online onto Square and wind Shopify down. **The Control Room is POS-agnostic** — it ingests aggregated sales from either, so the POS choice does **not** gate Candelo. Recommend Square now; treat the Shopify-online call as Jay's, made after soft open.
- Full reasoning: `Control_Room/BUILD_VS_BUY.md` (POS section).

DECISION 2 — INVENTORY/PRODUCTION: CRAFTYBASE VS THE CANDELO CONTROL ROOM (THE CENTRAL PRODUCT CONVERSATION)

- **Jay lists Craftybase (#1)**: recipes/BOM, batch + lot tracking, true COGS; ~\$24–59/mo (~\$1,188/yr).
- **Our build-vs-buy audit already KILLED Craftybase** — the Control Room **self-builds** the same production/recipes/batch/lot-trace/COGS at **\$0**, saving **~\$1,188/yr** (with Homebase, ~\$1,548/yr).
- **Candelo recommendation — the Control Room IS the Craftybase replacement**. It delivers weighted-average COGS + an append-only Material Ledger with current-lot traceability that is **regulator/insurer-defensible at Frontier's scale**, at \$0. **Honest revisit trigger**: if Frontier scales to high SKU/batch volume with many simultaneous open lots needing exact FIFO cost layers, or the accountant/insurer demands a *named* system, revisit Craftybase Indie as the fallback. Until then, build-don't-rent wins.
- **Present as a decision for the Jay conversation**, not a fait accompli — this is the heart of what Candelo's product replaces. Full case: `Control_Room/BUILD_VS_BUY.md`.

Entity finding (Branch G headline)

Candelo Group registered-entity status: UNCONFIRMED. Public web search surfaced no CA registration; the authoritative CA SOS bizfile search (bizfileonline.sos.ca.gov) is a JS app that could not be queried this session. Confirm or form the LLC before signing — a 2-minute bizfile lookup closes it (steps in doc G). **This is Candelo's entity, distinct from Jay's existing Frontier Organics LLC.**

True human-only blockers (cannot be done for them — exact missing input)

Legal/CPA (before signing): 1. **Attorney review of MSA/SOW** — sign-off that §2776 facts hold (doc B). *Not legal advice.* 2. **CPA review** — LLC tax status now / S-corp election later; 1099-NEC setup. *Not tax advice.* 3. **Jay's-side counsel review** of the contract.

Entity / holdout (Bill authorizes): 4. **Confirm/form Candelo Group LLC** (bizfile lookup or new filing). 5. **EIN** for the entity. 6. **Ceres/Modesto business license + tax registration.** 7. **Business bank account** for entity-to-entity invoicing. 8. **Publish the one-page offer site** (holds out to public — §2776 cond. 8; doc A is the content). 9. **Line up client #2** (independence proof — §2776 cond. 6–8).

Pilot activation (Jay provides): 10. **Sign MSA + SOW** (post-review). 11. **Logins** — Google Workspace (gating), Square (new) and/or Shopify, QBO, Gusto, bank, CDTFA (workflow access only; data boundary holds). 12. **Payment authorization** for Frontier's own rails. 13. **Jay's remaining answers** — gating four now ANSWERED by his plan (zoning ✓, scope ✓, date ✓ Aug 1, dairy ✓). Still open from Jay's side: **lease scope + CASp \$1938**, POS decision (Square), inventory decision (Control Room vs Craftybase), cleaning crew vs DIY, delivery-van plan. 14. **In-person/signature** — lease, permits (market permit ready in Branch I), inspections, insurance bind, label/claims counsel review, hiring.

Deploy (now phone-native, no Mac): 15. **One fine-grained GitHub PAT** (one-time, phone-doable). Then Claude pushes `push.sh` from the sandbox → GitHub Pages rebuilds. No Mac paste. (`_active/deploy_method_phone_native.md`)

Deploy — phone-native (GitHub Pages), replaces the surge Mac-paste

Per the locked standard method (`_active/deploy_method_phone_native.md`), deploys no longer require Bill's Mac. The hub lives in `_deploy/candelo-sites/frontier/` ; a push to GitHub triggers the Pages workflow on GitHub's servers.

```
GH_USER=<github-username> GH_TOKEN=<fine-grained-PAT> \  
  bash "/Users/candeloos/Documents/Claude/Projects/Candelo OS claude/  
_deploy/candelo-sites/push.sh"
```

Live URLs after connect: `https://<user>.github.io/candelo-sites/frontier/` **Only missing input:** the one-time fine-grained PAT (Contents/Workflows/Pages = read-write, scoped to the `candelo-sites` repo). Itself phone-doable in Safari or the GitHub iOS app. (*The legacy surge URL `https://frontier-package.surge.sh` keeps working until cutover.*)

THE OFFER — ONE PAGE

Candelo Control Room

AI Operations Partner for small brick-and-mortar.

You open it. I run it. One connected operating system runs your back office from day one, so you can run your store.

What it is

An AI-run back office, delivered as a service. You handle the opening — lease, build-out, permits, the storefront. Candelo plugs its **Control Room** into your business and **runs the daily operating work after the doors open** — the part that normally eats an owner's week or forces an early hire. You get monthly deliverables and a daily answer to one question: *what do we make, restock, fix, or stop selling next.*

You are not hiring a person. You are hiring an outside operations partner that already built the system.

What's included

The Control Room — your business's operating system, already built and ready to deploy:

- Raw materials to finished goods to inventory by location, in one connected flow (POS-agnostic — reads Square or Shopify)
- Daily closeout and an owner dashboard you actually read
- Weekly reporting that tells you what to act on
- Batch-to-shelf production and live COGS — the **Craftybase replacement**, built in at \$0
- Cold-chain temperature logging for frozen beef, raw dairy, and eggs
- Compliance tracking: claims, labeling, MoCRA, complaints and adverse events; returns + recall procedure
- Vendor and inventory management, reorder points, setup checklists, SOPs, CSV templates, vendor messages

The cadence at a glance:

- **Daily** — closeout, dashboard refresh, "what to do next" answer
- **Weekly** — reporting, restock and production calls, exception flags
- **Monthly** — full operating review and defined deliverables

Outcomes — what you stop worrying about

- One system behind your storefront: raw materials, production batches, released finished goods, inventory by location, and retail/online/pickup/market sales all connected
- A daily, plain answer to what to make, restock, fix, or stop selling
- Compliance handled and tracked, not improvised — including cold-chain temp logs and a recall procedure
- Roughly **\$1,548/yr** saved by replacing Craftybase (~\$1,188) and Homebase (~\$360) with Candelo's self-built production and scheduling modules
- The back office off your plate, without the cost, risk, and admin of an employee

Why a partner, not a hire

A ~\$72k/yr operations role really costs an owner ~**\$86k–\$94k all-in** once you add employer payroll taxes (FICA, FUTA, CA SUI/ETT), workers' comp, benefits, and payroll admin — plus exposure to overtime, wage-and-hour, unemployment, and wrongful-termination claims.

A monthly retainer to Candelo lands in the **same range or less, with none of the add-ons**: 100% deductible, no payroll, one 1099-NEC at year end.

It is also cleaner for *you*. Candelo operates as a real independent business — its own system and tools (the Control Room), its own business location in Ceres CA, defined monthly deliverables instead of hours, control over how the work gets done, free to take other clients, advertising the service, and setting its own rates. Under California's §2776 business-to-business exemption, that structure keeps the relationship a vendor relationship, not an employment one. Structured this way, the misclassification risk that would otherwise land on the owner simply isn't there.

Founding pilot

You'd be Candelo's founding Control Room client and the case study, with founding pricing locked.

- **Setup: \$0**
- **\$2,500/mo** (*Bill's final call*)
- **6-month pilot term**

Founding rate, below the standard band of ~\$3,500–\$6,000/mo for later clients, and well below the ~\$6–8k/mo true cost of a W-2 ops hire.

Next step

One short call to confirm fit and start onboarding. The system is built. We can be **live behind your storefront for the Aug 1 grand opening** — days, not months.

Not legal or tax advice — factual options under current California law (verified June 2026). Worker classification and entity/tax elections are fact-specific; confirm with a California employment attorney and a CPA before signing.

THE PITCH TO JAY

Pitch to Jay — "You open it, I run it"

Reframed June 24, 2026, against Jay's own *Frontier Organics — Briefing & Opening Plan (June 22)*.

The shift: Jay's plan is thorough. He's already nailed the *opening* — zoning (MU-P/C-2, by-right, no CUP), scope (cosmetics-only production, food as sealed resale), the Aug 1 date, the Week-1 filing order, the permit appendices. So the pitch is no longer "let me help you open." It's: **you open it, I run it**. Candelo's value is operating the store *after the doors open Aug 1* — the exact systems Jay's own plan names but doesn't staff: inventory/COGS, cold-chain temp logging, recall/complaints, daily reporting, dashboards, reorder. The Control Room is the live back-office from day one.

Two versions below: the full message to paste and send, and a 3-bullet TL;DR.

Email / text version (paste and send)

Hey Jay,

Read your opening plan top to bottom — it's tight. You've got zoning sorted (MU-P, by-right, no CUP), the scope locked clean (cosmetics melt/mix/fill only, all the food as sealed resale so you dodge the USDA path entirely), Aug 1 dated, and the whole Week-1 filing order laid out. Honestly the opening is handled. So I'm not pitching you on opening the store.

I'm pitching you on **running it after it opens**.

Your plan names a back office without naming who runs it. Look at your own list: inventory and true COGS, barcode/label system, cold-chain temperature logging for the beef and dairy, a returns and recall procedure, reorder points, daily cash close, the pricing-and-margin sheet per category. That's not opening work — that's *every day after Aug 1* work, and it's the part that eats an owner's week or forces an early hire. **That's the part I run.**

I run it through a system I've already built called the **Control Room**. One connected flow: raw tallow and materials into production batches, batches into released finished goods, finished goods into inventory by location, then retail, market, online, pickup — all tied together. Cold-chain temp logs, complaints and adverse-event tracking, claim/MoCRA review, reorder alerts. And every single day you get one straight answer: **what do we make, restock, fix, or stop selling next**. Live from the day you open.

Two things in your plan are decisions, and I want to be straight on both:

- **POS — you put Square first, and I agree.** It's free to start, runs register + markets + online, no contract. Go Square. The only thing to decide together is your existing Shopify online store — keep it for online and run Square in the shop, or move everything to Square later. Doesn't matter much to me: the Control Room reads your sales either way.
- **Inventory — you put Craftybase first. Here's where I'll push.** Craftybase is ~\$1,200 a year for recipes, batches, lot tracking, and COGS. The Control Room already does all of that — built, \$0, and traceable enough to defend to your insurer and the county. So my honest take is the Control Room *replaces* Craftybase, not sits next to it. If you ever scale to the point an auditor wants a brand-name MRP, we add Craftybase then. Until then you keep the ~\$1,200. I'd rather show you the module live and let you make the call.

The money side is the easy part. If you hired someone to run this at ~\$72k salary, the real cost to you is ~\$86k–\$94k a year once you add payroll taxes, workers' comp, benefits, and admin — never mind the overtime and termination exposure that comes with a W-2. My founding rate is **\$2,500/mo**. Same work, a fraction of the cost, 100% deductible, one 1099 at year end.

One thing I want to be straight about: we do this as **Candelo the business**, not Bill your employee. That's not a technicality — it protects *you*. Candelo has its own system (the Control Room), its own location in Ceres, its own other clients, and I deliver defined monthly outputs, not clocked hours. Under California's §2776 B2B rule, that keeps this a clean vendor relationship. Structured loose — me as your full-time right hand — the state could call it employment and *you'd* be on the hook for back payroll taxes. Doing it right keeps that off you entirely.

The terms, plainly:

- **\$0 setup**
- **\$2,500/mo** founding rate, locked
- **6-month pilot**
- Frontier is the founding case study, so you get founding pricing nobody else will

And to put my money where my mouth is: **I already took your single remaining regulatory long pole off your plate**. Your plan says the county market permit is the one thing left and it has to be faxed to DER. I've pre-filled the whole application to your Appendix A spec — New Business, Market, 2,001–6,000 sq ft, within city limits — plus a fax cover sheet. You sign two lines and fax it. First visible thing I do for you, before a dollar changes hands.

If this sounds right, let's grab 20 minutes this week. I'll walk you through the Control Room live — the production module, the cold-chain logs, the daily "what to do next" — and we lock the Square and inventory calls together. Then we're live behind the store for Aug 1.

Talk soon, Bill

If he wants the short version (TL;DR)

- **You open it, I run it**. Your plan nailed the opening (zoning, scope, Aug 1, filings). The part it doesn't staff — inventory/COGS, cold-chain temp logs, recall/complaints, daily close, reorder, reporting — is exactly what I run, live from day one, through the Control Room I've already built.
- **Two calls**: Square for POS (agree with you) and — my one push — the Control Room *replaces* Craftybase (\$0 vs ~\$1,200/yr, same batches/lots/COGS, insurer-defensible). I'll show you live and you decide.
- **\$2,500/mo** vs the ~\$86k–\$94k/yr a real ops hire costs you — fully deductible, no payroll, done as Candelo-the-business so the classification risk stays off you. \$0 setup, 6-month pilot. And I've already pre-filled your county market permit (the one regulatory item left) — sign + fax.

Not legal or tax advice — factual options under current California law (verified June 2026). Worker classification and entity/tax elections are fact-specific; confirm with a California employment attorney and a CPA before signing.

FIRST DELIVERABLE — MARKET PERMIT, PRE-FILLED

The one regulatory item left — pre-filled, ready to sign + fax

Jay's plan names the **Stanislaus County DER retail "market" permit** as the *single remaining regulatory long pole*. This is Candelo taking it off his plate: every field on the county's one-page application is answered below, plus a fax cover sheet. **Jay prints the official form, copies these answers, signs, and faxes. That's it.**

Important — submit the county's OWN form. Per Appendix A, the official one-page application must be printed from the county and faxed in; a copy is not accepted. This document is the **answer key + cover sheet**, not a substitute for the official form. Download it here: stancounty.com/er/pdf/application-food-facility-permits.pdf

Where it goes

Agency	Stanislaus County Dept. of Environmental Resources (DER)
Mailing address	3800 Cornucopia Way, Suite C, Modesto, CA 95358
Phone	209-525-6700
FAX the completed form to	209-525-6774 (no e-filing)

Before you fax — one 5-minute call (Candelo will draft the script): ask DER whether the move-in-ready building needs a **plan review** for first-time food use or can go **straight to inspection**, and confirm the **market-category fee** (+ any plan-check fee). Note that the cosmetic melt/mix/fill room is a **separate use** from the food (resale) area.

ANSWER KEY — copy these onto the official form

FORM FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER	WHY
Requested action	☒ New Business	First-time food facility at this address
This application is for	☒ Market (not Restaurant / Bakery / Bar)	Retail market: packaged goods + sealed-resale frozen/dairy; no dine-in, no on-site food processing
Square Footage	☒ 2,001 to 6,000	Building is ~2,740 sq ft
Seating Capacity	☒ 0 to 20	Retail market, no dine-in seating
Facility name	Frontier Organics – Local Natural Provisions	DBA the store will operate under
Facility address	429 McHenry Ave, Modesto, CA 95354	The store
Within City Limits	☒ YES	Modesto city limits
On-site phone	[STORE PHONE – fill in]	The store's line

FORM FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER	WHY
On-site email	[STORE EMAIL – fill in]	Monitored inbox
Owner / company name	Frontier Organics LLC	Per Jay's plan, the LLC already exists; the store name is a DBA under it
Owner mailing address	[ALTERNATE ADDRESS – fill in]	Must NOT be the facility and NOT a PO box (county rule)
Owner phone / email	[OWNER CONTACT – fill in]	
Signature	Sign as Manager/Owner	Jay (or authorized manager)
Date	Date of signing	

Four brackets for Jay to fill: store phone, store email, owner alternate mailing address (not the store, not a PO box), owner contact. Everything else is decided.

FAX COVER SHEET (print this page, put it on top)

FAX TRANSMITTAL

T0:

Stanislaus County Dept. of Environmental Resources (DER)

FAX:

209-525-6774

FROM:

Frontier Organics LLC – dba Frontier Organics, Local Natural Provisions

429 McHenry Ave, Modesto, CA 95354

CONTACT:

[OWNER NAME] · [OWNER PHONE] · [OWNER EMAIL]

DATE:

PAGES:

_____ (this cover + the completed application = _____ pages)

RE:

Application for Food Facility Permit – NEW BUSINESS (MARKET)

429 McHenry Ave, Modesto, CA 95354

MESSAGE:

Please find attached our completed Application for Food Facility Permit for a new retail market at the above address (within city limits, ~2,740 sq ft, no dine-in seating). The facility sells packaged goods and house-brand cosmetics, with frozen grass-fed beef, raw dairy, and eggs offered as sealed, pre-packaged vendor-stocked resale (no on-site food processing or repackaging). A small cosmetic melt/mix/fill area is a separate, by-right accessory use.

Please advise whether a plan review is required for first-time food use at this move-in-ready space, or whether we may proceed directly to a pre-opening inspection, and confirm the market-category permit fee (and any plan-check fee).

Thank you.

[OWNER SIGNATURE / NAME]

What Candelo handles next (so this doesn't stall)

Once the fax goes out, the Control Room tracks it as a live readiness row to the **Aug 1** date: - DER response (plan review vs straight-to-inspection) + fee confirmation - the **rest of the Week-1 filing order** (Appendix B): EIN → CDTFA seller's permit → DBA → city business license → this food permit → FDA/MoCRA → food handler cards — sequenced and tracked - the **dairy-farm permit verification** (CDFA Market Milk Permit + bottling) as a vendor-qualification row

Not legal advice — this is a clerical pre-fill of a county form per Jay's own Appendix A. Confirm fees and plan-review status directly with DER (209-525-6700).

6-WEEK COUNTDOWN TO AUG 1

6-Week Countdown to Aug 1 — who does what

Owner key: **J** = Jay (owner actions — sign, pay, in-person, hire) · **C** = Candelo (systems, tracking, drafting, the back office) · **C+J** = shared (Candelo preps, Jay executes/decides) · **V** = vendor/contractor (Jay engages, Candelo tracks).

The regulatory/opening track is Jay's (his plan nailed it); the **operating track is Candelo's** — and the two run in parallel so the Control Room is live *the day the doors open*. Confirmed: zoning (by-right, no CUP), scope (cosmetics-only production; food = sealed resale), raw-dairy resale (no extra license). The single regulatory long pole is the county market permit — **pre-filled and ready to fax (Doc H)**.

WEEK 1 · Jun 22–28 (now) — file the long pole + power up the building

OWNER	ACTION
C+J	Fax the Stanislaus County market permit (Doc H pre-fill: New Business / Market / 2,001–6,000 sq ft / 0–20 seating / within city limits = Yes) → fax 209-525-6774 . Call DER first (209-525-6700): plan-review vs straight-to-inspection + fee.
C+J	Start the filing order (Appendix B): EIN (if new entity) → CDTFA seller's permit (free, online) → DBA "Frontier Organics – Local Natural Provisions" (County Clerk, ~\$40) → City of Modesto business license . Candelo pre-fills each; Jay signs/submits.
J	Order internet Day 1 — AT&T Business Fiber (check 429 McHenry) or Comcast Xfinity Business; add 5G failover for POS. (Installs take 1–2+ weeks — order first.)
J / V	Utilities into business name (PG&E, City water/sewer, trash); new security system w/ a NEW company (baseline RAND \$220/qtr); decide cleaning crew vs DIY (lean crew given timeline).
C	Stand up the Control Room on Frontier's Google Workspace; load the readiness board with every row below, dated to Aug 1.
C+J	Decision call: lock POS = Square + the inventory call (Control Room vs Craftybase — Candelo demos the production module live).

WEEK 2 · Jun 29–Jul 5 — licenses in flight + the store starts taking shape

OWNER	ACTION
C+J	FDA / MoCRA registration + product listing (Frontier Organics, Tallips, TALO) — Candelo drafts; note the small-business exemption + eye/oral carve-outs (RESEARCH_FACTS B).
J	Bind insurance — general liability, product liability (critical: skincare + raw dairy), property/ contents, workers' comp. Candelo has the broker message ready.
J / V	Begin fixtures — metal shelving, cabinets, displays; confirm Modesto sign permit + front signage (local sign co. or Neil).
C	Build the pricing & margin sheet per category (house brands / food / goods) — keystone-on-keystone floor, target COGS ≤30% (RESEARCH_FACTS C).
C	Stand up cold-chain temp-logging + receiving workflows for the freezers (beef, dairy, eggs).
J	Publish the DBA newspaper notice (4 weekly runs — start now so it clears before/around opening).

WEEK 3 · Jul 6–12 — compliance spine + vendor onboarding

OWNER	ACTION
C+J	Food handler cards for Jay + any staff (online, ~\$15 each).
C	Claim/labeling review — run every house product through the green/yellow/red tracker; no high-risk claim becomes shelf signage/POS copy until reviewed (RESEARCH_FACTS B per-product verdicts).
C+J	Vendor & sourcing compliance — signed vendor/consignment agreements (honey, candles, eggs, woodwork); collect COAs; verify each food vendor's permits ; resale certificates.
C+J	Raw-dairy : get WRITTEN proof the farm holds a current CDFA Market Milk Permit + bottling licensing ; confirm sealed-only handling. Candelo tracks as a vendor-qualification row.
J / V	Buy stainless work tables + ingredient storage to fill out the melt/mix/fill area (production equipment already in place).

WEEK 4 · Jul 13–19 — inventory loaded + POS configured

OWNER	ACTION
C	Barcode / label system for house SKUs + vendor goods; SKU cleanup (<code>sku_ready</code> / <code>do_not_sell_until_identified</code>).
C+J	Configure Square (register + markets) and connect the Control Room sales feed; decide Shopify-online keep-vs-consolidate (defer migration to post-soft-open).
C	Load the production module — recipes, materials w/ lot+cost, first batches → released finished goods → inventory by location.
J / V	Confirm Certificate of Occupancy covers retail + accessory production; verify electrical/plumbing sound; ADA + handwash sink per any plan check.
J	Hire / schedule staff; assign roles (register, restocking, production room).

WEEK 5 · Jul 20–26 — stock, inspect, dry-run the systems

OWNER	ACTION
J / V	Pass DER pre-opening inspection → permit issues (CA Retail Food Code §114381). Schedule early in the week to leave buffer.
J / V	First freezer stock-up with dairy/meat supplier (set the weekly cadence); stock house brands + vendor goods; set planogram.
C	Daily closeout + dashboard dry-run with real-ish data; reorder points set; returns/recall procedure documented.
C+J	Cash handling + opening float ; confirm complaint/adverse-event log + same-day escalation flags.
C	Launch presence — Google Business Profile + Apple Maps; tie store IG/TikTok to the existing audience.

WEEK 6 · Jul 27–Aug 1 — soft open, fix, grand open

DATE	OWNER	ACTION
Jul 27–28 (Mon–Tue)	C+J	Final readiness go/no-go: every readiness row green; permit in hand; insurance bound; POS + Control Room live.
Jul 29–30 (Wed–Thu)	C+J	SOFT OPEN — dial in flow, POS, staffing, and the daily closeout on live transactions. Candelo runs the back office in real time; fix what the soft open exposes.
Jul 31 (Fri)	C+J	Restock from soft-open learnings; final temp-log + cash-float check; grand-opening promo staged.
Aug 1 (Sat)	J + C	GRAND OPEN. Jay runs the floor; Candelo runs the operation — live inventory/ COGS, cold-chain logs, daily "what to make/restock/fix/stop," reporting from day one. Cross-promote at Central Valley farmers markets.

The critical path (don't let these slip)

1. **Market permit fax** → **DER response** → **inspection** (Week 1 → Week 5). The longest pole — started Day 1.
2. **Internet install** (order Week 1; 1–2+ weeks) — 5G failover is the safety net for POS on opening day.
3. **Insurance bound before any sale** (Week 2) — product liability is non-negotiable for consumables + raw dairy.
4. **DBA newspaper publication** (starts Week 2; 4 weekly runs) — start early so it clears.
5. **Inspection pass** (Week 5) — leaves a one-week buffer before soft open.

What's Candelo's vs Jay's, in one line

Jay opens it — lease, build-out, permits, inspections, insurance, hiring, the storefront. **Candelo runs it** — the Control Room and everything that operates the store after Aug 1: inventory, COGS, cold-chain logs, claims/MoCRA, complaints/recall, reorder, daily close, reporting, dashboards.

Dates are calendar-anchored to Jay's plan. Confirm fees, inspection slots, and install windows directly with each agency/vendor — those set the real critical path.